

All-In-One Disposable Tea Cups

Pour water. Sip. Toss. Convenience for the gloriously lazy.

What It Is

A physical product business selling disposable cups with the tea already built in. Loose tea sits in a filter at the bottom of the cup — guests just add hot water and drink, no tea bags to unwrap, no leaves floating, no dishes to wash afterward. You import them cheaply, brand them, and sell online and to offices, hotels, and event venues.

How It Makes Money

You buy in bulk from China and resell at a multiple, either direct-to-consumer in multi-packs or wholesale to businesses that hand them out. The product sells pure convenience, and convenience is a market that never runs dry. Buyers: busy households, offices, Airbnb hosts, cafes, and event planners who want a fast, mess-free tea service.

Startup Costs

- Initial inventory, 1,000–2,000 units from Alibaba: \$400–\$1,200
- Custom branding / printed sleeves: \$150–\$400
- Product photography: \$0 (DIY) – \$200
- Shopify store + apps: ~\$40/month
- Packaging for multi-packs: \$100–\$250
- Samples & shipping to test quality: \$80–\$200
- Total to launch: **\$800–\$2,300**

The Numbers

Imported cost from Alibaba runs about **\$0.25–\$0.55 per cup** depending on tea quality and order size, plus roughly **\$0.10–\$0.20/unit landed** for sea freight and duties. Sell as a **12-pack for \$18–\$24** (so ~\$1.50–\$2.00 each), giving a profit of around **\$1.00–\$1.40 per cup** after fees. Move 400 packs/month at \$20 = **\$8,000 revenue**, roughly **\$4,500–\$5,500 gross profit** before ads. Wholesale orders to offices and hotels are lower margin but much higher volume.

How To Start

1. Source 3–5 suppliers on Alibaba for "disposable tea cup with built-in filter"; order samples from each.
2. Test brew quality, lid seal, and filter performance — reject anything that leaks or tastes weak.
3. Pick a niche flavor lineup (green, jasmine, fruit) and design simple branded sleeves.
4. Place a 1,000–2,000 unit first order; ship by sea to keep landed cost low.
5. Build a Shopify store with lifestyle photos showing the "pour and go" moment.
6. List multi-packs and launch with short demo videos on TikTok/Instagram.
7. Reinvest early profit into bigger orders to drop per-unit cost and add flavors.

Where To Get Customers

Direct-to-consumer through TikTok and Instagram demo reels showing the satisfying "just add water" reveal — this product films well. Sell on Amazon and Etsy for search-driven buyers. For wholesale, pitch coworking spaces, boutique hotels, and Airbnb superhosts who want effortless guest amenities. Gift-market it for holidays as a tea sampler.

Pro Tips

- **Lead with the demo video.** The "no bag, no mess, no dishes" reveal sells itself — static photos won't.
- **Order samples from multiple suppliers first.** Filter and lid quality vary wildly; a leaky cup kills repeat sales.
- **Stack a wholesale channel under your DTC store.** Offices and hotels buy in bulk and reorder predictably, smoothing out ad-dependent retail sales.